Lesson 5: AI for Sales and Customer Messages

Module 2 | 60 minutes | Honest sales messages | Adults (18+) · ages 18–65

Objective: Choose your sales path and use AI to write lead follow-ups, handle common objections, reply on WhatsApp and email, and turn call notes into clear CRM notes, while following strict honesty rules.

Success criteria

- I can write a follow-up sequence with a new helpful reason in each message.
- I can get calm, honest replies to common objections and remove invented claims.
- I can turn rough call notes into a CRM note without adding anything.
- I can follow the honesty rules for sales messages, opt-in and bots.

Key vocabulary

- **lead**: A person or company that has shown interest and might buy.
- **follow-up sequence**: A planned set of messages, like day 3, day 7 and day 14, each with a new reason to reply.
- **objection**: A reason a customer gives for not buying yet, like price or timing.
- **CRM**: Where a team keeps customer notes and next steps; even a shared sheet can be a simple CRM.
- **opt-in**: When a customer agrees to receive your messages.
- **fake urgency**: Pressure that is not true, like “only 2 left” when you have plenty.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash and the AI tools for this lesson
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone)
- Learner accounts only where allowed: see the course safety notes
- Printed worksheet (optional)
- Project files: l05_follow_up_kit.md, l05_teacher_demo_script.md

Timed lesson plan (60 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	“Objection ping-pong” (see Unplugged).
5 min	**Watch + choose your path**	Play the lesson video. Poll: everyone types A, B or C in the chat; form breakout groups by path.
7 min	**Live demo**	Path A objection (invented warranty catch), path B sequence, path C CRM note (“free” catch), quick replies and the CRM sheet.

9 min	**Prompt Labs**	Prompt Lab: a follow-up sequence, then rough notes to a CRM note. Test in two chatbots and compare.
13 min	**Build along (path groups)**	Breakout rooms by path: build steps 1–5. Each group shares one objection reply in the chat before returning.
7 min	**Team games**	Quick competition: “Honest or rewrite?” sort in two teams, then the objection match as a speed round, then “Who can you message?” as a poll.
6 min	**Show-and-tell**	One learner from each path reads a before (pushy) and after (honest) message.
4 min	**Probe**	New situation: “Are you a real person?” (individual).
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket; homework: save the kit and use one sequence for real.

Unplugged warm-up

Objection ping-pong (5 min): the teacher plays a customer and throws objections (“too expensive”, “I’ll think about it”, “the shop next door is cheaper”). Volunteers have 10 seconds to reply out loud with a question, not a speech. The class scores each reply: did it ask a question? Was it honest? Then say: “Today the AI will draft these for you, and you will check them for honesty.”

Teaching the idea

Module 2 is about the learner’s own role. Today: sales and customer messages. Learners choose a path (A shop owner, B sales to companies, C service business) and every task has an example for each path. Four skills: follow-up sequences, objection replies, WhatsApp/email replies saved as quick replies or templates, and CRM notes from rough call notes. The heart of the lesson is the honesty rules: true facts only, no fake urgency, no fake reviews, message only people who agreed, stop when asked, and a bot must say it is a bot. Caught mistakes: an invented warranty and competitor claim, and the word “free” slipped into a CRM note.

Analogy: AI in sales is like a very fast assistant who has read every sales book but has never seen your shop: great at words, but you tell it the facts and you sign every message.

Live demo: 1) Ask learners to type their path (A, B or C) in the chat. 2) Paste the path A objection prompt into ChatGPT; read the reply and hunt for anything not in our facts (competitor material, warranty length). If the AI stays accurate, show the video version. 3) Paste the path B sequence prompt into Claude; ask “Is every offer something we really do?” 4) Paste the path C rough notes into Gemini; look for added words like “free”. 5) Show WhatsApp Business quick replies (or a Gmail template) and the simple CRM sheet sorted by follow-up date. 6) Read the honesty rules aloud and ask for a thumbs up on each.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for

What makes a good follow-up message?	A new, helpful reason to reply, the real facts, short, and no pressure.
Name two things the AI must never invent in a sales message.	Any two: discounts, warranties, reviews, stock levels, deadlines, competitor claims.
What is a CRM, in plain words?	Where a team keeps customer notes and next steps, even a shared sheet.
Whom can you message on WhatsApp for business?	People who agreed to hear from you; stop when they ask.
What must an automated assistant say if asked whether it is a person?	That it is an automated assistant, and offer a person.

Differentiation

Support
Give learners the ready prompts from the kit for their path; they only change the facts in brackets and check the reply against the honesty rules.

Stretch
Ask the AI to rewrite the follow-up sequence in Hindi or Marathi (check with a fluent speaker) and to suggest one honest reason to reply for each month of the year (festivals, monsoon, exams, year end).

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
A pushy message sells more.	Helpful, honest follow-ups build trust and repeat customers; pressure loses them.
If the AI wrote a claim, it must be true.	The AI does not know your products. Check every fact, number and promise.
Bought number lists are fine for WhatsApp.	Message only people who agreed to hear from you.
A CRM is expensive software.	A shared sheet with dates and next steps is a simple CRM.

Assessment

Use the Prompt Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write one sales line the AI might suggest that breaks the honesty rules, and rewrite it honestly.

Homework
Finish your follow-up kit and use one sequence for a real lead this week (with placeholders filled in by you). Note any reply you got.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Prompt Lab: a follow-up sequence (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Say who the lead is · Give the real facts of what happened · Give the timing · Set the length · A new helpful reason each time · An honesty rule · How the last message ends

Strong example:

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I run a coaching centre. A parent, [Parent name], enquired on Monday about our Class 10 Maths weekend batch and asked for the fee details, which I sent the same day. Write a 3-message WhatsApp follow-up sequence (day 3, day 7, day 14), each under 50 words, each with a new helpful reason to reply, such as a demo class date or the batch timetable. Use only true facts I give you; no fake urgency and do not invent offers. The last message should politely close the loop.
```

2. Prompt Lab: rough notes to a CRM note (perform · ai lab)

Checklist: Name the main fields · Include a follow-up date · Include decision maker and objections · Say personal details are removed · Tell the AI not to add anything · Ask it to flag unclear points

Strong example:

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Turn my rough call notes into a CRM note with these fields: Need, Budget, Decision maker, Objections, Next step, Follow-up date. I removed the phone number and used the customer code C-214. Do not add anything that is not in the notes. If something is unclear or missing, write “Not mentioned” and flag it. Notes: [paste notes].
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3. Honest sales message, or rewrite it? (perform · categorize)

Honest: OK to send: “Prices go up on 1 Dec, as the supplier has announced”, “Would Thursday or Friday suit you for a demo?”, “This is my last follow-up; reply any time you need us”, “Here are two photos of the actual table you will receive”
Not honest: rewrite it: “Only 2 left in stock!” (you have 40), “Rated 5 stars by 1,000+ customers” (you have 12 reviews), “Our competitor’s tables break within a month” (no proof), Writing a Google review as a “happy customer” yourself

4. Match each objection to a good way to answer it (perform · matching)

“It’s too expensive” → Ask what matters most, show real value, offer a real cheaper option if one exists · “I’ll think about it” → Ask what is holding them back and agree a follow-up date · “Another shop is cheaper” → Compare true facts politely; never run down the competitor · “Not the right time” → Ask when would suit them and set a reminder · “I don’t know your company” → Share genuine proof: real reviews, a sample, a visit or a demo

5. Who can you message? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: Only the 300 who agreed, with an easy way to stop messages

6. New situation: “Are you a real person?” (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Say honestly that it is an automated assistant, and pass the discount question to a person

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** lead = A person or company that has shown interest and might buy. · follow-up sequence = A planned set of messages, like day 3, day 7 and day 14, each with a new reason to reply. · objection = A reason a customer gives for not buying yet, like price or timing. · CRM = Where a team keeps customer notes and next steps; even a shared sheet can be a simple CRM.
2. **Prompt Lab: a follow-up sequence:** Include: Say who the lead is; Give the real facts of what happened; Give the timing; Set the length; A new helpful reason each time; An honesty rule; How the last message ends. Example: I run a coaching centre. A parent, [Parent name], enquired on Monday about our Class 10 Maths weekend batch and asked for the fee details, which I sent the same day. Write a 3-message WhatsApp follow-up sequence (day 3, day 7, day 14), each under 50 words, each with a new helpful reason to reply, such as a demo class date or the batch timetable. Use only true facts I give you; no fake urgency and do not invent offers. The last message should politely close the loop.
3. **Prompt Lab: rough notes to a CRM note:** Include: Name the main fields; Include a follow-up date; Include decision maker and objections; Say personal details are removed; Tell the AI not to add anything; Ask it to flag unclear points. Example: Turn my rough call notes into a CRM note with these fields: Need, Budget, Decision maker, Objections, Next step, Follow-up date. I removed the phone number and used the customer code C-214. Do not add anything that is not in the notes. If something is unclear or missing, write “Not mentioned” and flag it. Notes: [paste notes].
4. **Honest sales message, or rewrite it?:** Honest: OK to send: “Prices go up on 1 Dec, as the supplier has announced”, “Would Thursday or Friday suit you for a demo?”, “This is my last follow-up; reply any time you need us”, “Here are two photos of the actual table you will receive” · Not honest: rewrite it: “Only 2 left in stock!” (you have 40), “Rated 5 stars by 1,000+ customers” (you have 12 reviews), “Our competitor’s tables break within a month” (no proof), Writing a Google review as a “happy customer” yourself
5. **Match each objection to a good way to answer it:** “It’s too expensive” → Ask what matters most, show real value, offer a real cheaper option if one exists · “I’ll think about it” → Ask what is holding them back and agree a follow-up date · “Another shop is cheaper” → Compare true facts politely; never run down the competitor · “Not the right time” → Ask when would suit them and set a reminder · “I don’t know your company” → Share genuine proof: real reviews, a sample, a visit or a demo

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